

Curriculum Vitae

Alex L. Jones

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Alex L. Jones, PhD

Associate Professor of Psychological Data Science
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Google Scholar

Research interests

Face perception; facial morphometrics and geometric morphometric methods; first impressions and social trait inference; Bayesian inference and hierarchical modelling; psychometrics and latent-variable modelling; psychological data science.

Education

PhD, Psychology — Bangor University, 2010–2013. Pass with no corrections.

BSc (Hons), Psychology — Bangor University, 2007–2010. First Class.

Employment

Associate Professor of Psychological Data Science — School of Psychology, Swansea University, 2025–present.

Senior Lecturer in Psychology — Swansea University, 2020–2025.

Lecturer in Psychology — Swansea University, 2016–2020.

Postdoctoral Research Associate — Gettysburg College, USA, 2014–2015.

Postdoctoral Research Associate — Bangor University, 2013–2014.

Teaching

Module convenership

PSY334 — Evolutionary Perspectives on Psychology, Swansea University. Module lead. Final year undergraduate module.

PSM-99 - Quantitative Perspectives on Psychology - from Measurement to Models, Swansea University. Module Lead. MSc Research Methods module.

Online courses (open access)

Data Analysis with Python — alexjonesphd.github.io/python_data_analysis. A free introduction to the Python scientific stack for social-science researchers.

Statistical Modelling with Python — alexjonesphd.github.io/statistical_models_python. A more advanced course on building and interpreting statistical models in Python, including Bayesian methods with PyMC.

Teaching qualifications

PGCertHE / Fellow of AdvanceHE (FHEA), 2018.

Research supervision

PhD — Three students supervised to completion in last 5 years.

MSc thesis supervision — 3–6 students per year over the past decade.

BSc dissertation supervision — 7–10 students per year over the past decade.

Service

Grant review

Grant panel member, Research Foundation – Flanders (FWO), 2024–2025.

Ad hoc grant reviewer — Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC, UK); Czech Science Foundation.

Editorial roles

PLOS ONE - 2019-2023 Evolution and Human Behaviour - 2022-Present

Professional memberships

Experimental Psychology Society.

Industry consulting

Consulting and applied research collaborations with industry partners on behavioural and psychological data, including Boots, Chanel, CyDen Ltd, eharmony, and Vanquis.

Technical skills

Programming — Python (advanced; primary research language), R.

Probabilistic programming — PyMC (primary), with experience in Stan and bambi.

Statistical methods — Bayesian hierarchical modelling, structural equation modelling, item response theory, generalised linear and mixed-effects models, geometric morphometric methods, multivariate methods.

Open Science — All recent work shared via OSF (osf.io/v3p5g); code on GitHub (github.com/alexjonesphd).

Publications

PDFs and DOIs available at alexjonesphd.github.io/publications.}

2026

- Jaeger, B., **Jones, A. L.**, Satchell, L., Schild, C., & van Leeuwen, F. (2026). Who likes extraverts? Testing the interplay between perceiver needs and target appearance in impression formation. *International Review of Social Psychology*, 39(1): 2, 1–13.

2025

- Satchell, L. P., Hall, J., & **Jones, A. L.** (2025). Do we look at a threatening person's face? The relationship between perception and observation of walking strangers. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*.

- Kramer, R. S. S., **Jones, A. L.**, Fitousi, D., & Tree, J. J. (2025). AI-generated images of familiar faces are indistinguishable from real photographs. *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*, 10(70).
- **Jones, A. L.**, Kordsmeyer, T. L., Kramer, R. S. S., Stern, J., & Penke, L. (2025). Updating evidence on facial metrics: A Bayesian perspective on sexual dimorphism in facial width-to-height ratio and bizygomatic width. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 46, 106781.
- Rayner, C. L., Davies, J., Bradshaw, C. A., & **Jones, A. L.** (2025). Patterns of recreational substance use, help seeking and harm reduction among UK music festival attendees. *Drug Science, Policy and Law*, 11, 1–12.
- Kannan, C., **Jones, A. L.**, Towler, J., & Tree, J. J. (2025). Do young and older adult populations perform equivalently across different automatic face-trait judgements? Evidence for differential impacts of ageing. *PLOS ONE*, 20(5), e0322165.
- Kramer, R. S. S., **Jones, A. L.**, & Fitousi, D. (2025). Face familiarity and similarity: Within- and between-identity representations are altered by learning. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception & Performance*.
- Tree, J. J., Kramer, R. S. S., & **Jones, A. L.** (2025). Upright and inverted unfamiliar face-matching tasks — everything correlates everywhere all at once. *Memory & Cognition*.
- Tree, J. J., & **Jones, A. L.** (2025). Exploring insight into unfamiliar face recognition ability: The case from developmental prosopagnosia. *Cortex*.
- Tree, J. J., & **Jones, A. L.** (2025). How prevalent is “other ethnicity blindness”? Exploring the extremes of recognition performance across categories of faces. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*.
- James, M. L., Stiles, V. H., von Lieres un Wilkau, H. C., **Jones, A.**, Willy, R. W., Ashford, K. J., & Moore, I. S. (2025). Predictors of pelvic acceleration during treadmill running across various stride frequency conditions. *Sports Biomechanics*, 1–15.

2024

- Kramer, R. S. S., Javorkova, N., & **Jones, A.** (2024). No influence of face familiarity on the cheerleader effect. *Visual Cognition*, 1–11.
- **Jones, A.**, Shiramizu, V., & Jones, B. C. (2024). Decoding the language of first impressions: Comparing models of first impressions of faces derived from free-text descriptions and trait ratings. *British Journal of Psychology*, 1–16.
- Kramer, R. S. S., Ritchie, K. L., Flack, T. R., Mireku, M. O., & **Jones, A.** (2024). The psychometrics of rating facial attractiveness using different response scales. *Perception*, 1–16.
- Jaeger, B., Slegers, W. W. A., Stern, J., Penke, L., & **Jones, A.** (2024). Testing perceivers’ accuracy and accuracy awareness when forming personality impressions from faces. *European Journal of Personality*, 1–21.

2023

- Kramer, R. S. S., Jarvis, J.-L., Green, M., & **Jones, A.** (2023). The relationship between facial attractiveness and perceived guilt across crime type. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 1–9.
- Satchell, L. P., Jaeger, B., **Jones, A.**, López, B., & Schild, C. (2023). Beyond reliability in first impressions research: Considering validity and the need to “mix it up with folks”. *Social Psychological Bulletin*, 18, e10211.
- Kramer, R. S. S., Flanagan, E., **Jones, A.**, & Gous, G. (2023). Wisdom of the inner crowd benefits both face and voice matching. *Applied Cognitive Psychology*, 1–9.
- Turner, A. D., Ong, J. C., **Jones, A.**, Tu, A., Salanitro, & Crawford, M. R. (2023). Neurocognitive functioning in comorbid insomnia and sleep apnea patients is better after positive airway pressure therapy, but worse after cognitive behavioral therapy for insomnia. *Sleep*, 46, 1–12.
- Bobak, A. K., **Jones, A.**, Hilker, Z., Mestry, N., Bate, S., & Hancock, P. J. B. (2023). Data-driven studies in face identity processing rely on the quality of the tests and data sets. *Cortex*, 166, 348–364.
- Embling, R., Price, M. J., Lee, M. D., **Jones, A.**, & Wilkinson, L. L. (2023). Associations between dietary variety, portion size and body weight: Prospective evidence from UK Biobank participants. *British Journal of Nutrition*, 1–11.
- Hadden, L. M., Penny, H., **Jones, A.**, Partridge, A. M., Lancaster, T. M., & Allen, C. (2023). Pre-frontal stimulation does not reliably increase reward responsiveness. *Cortex*, 159, 268–285.

2022

- Batres, C., **Jones, A.**, Barlett, C. P., Porcheron, A., Morizot, F., & Russell, R. (2022). Makeup works by modifying factors of facial beauty. *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts*.

- Kramer, R. S. S., & **Jones, A.** (2022). Incomplete faces are completed using a more average face. *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*, 7:708.
- Childs, M. J., & **Jones, A.** (2022). Perceptions of individuals who engage in age concealment. *Evolutionary Behavioral Sciences*.
- Ong, J., Dawson, S., Taylor, H., Park, M., Burgess, H., Crawford, M., Rains, J., Smitherman, T., Espie, C., **Jones, A.**, & Wyatt, J. (2022). A micro-longitudinal study of naps, sleep disturbance, and headache severity in women with chronic migraine. *Behavioural Sleep Medicine*.
- Jaeger, B., & **Jones, A.** (2022). Which facial features are central in impression formation? *Social Psychological and Personality Science*, 13(2), 553–561.

2021

- **Jones, A.** (2021). Height shows no clear association with self-serving beliefs about wealth redistribution: A commentary on Richardson (2020). *Evolution and Human Behaviour*, 42, 593–596.
- Kramer, R., & **Jones, A.** (2021). Wanting or having children predicts age preferences in online dating. *Evolutionary Behavioral Sciences*.
- Holzleitner, I., **Jones, A.**, O'Shea, K., Cassar, R., Fasolt, V., Shiramizu, V., Jones, B., & DeBruine, L. (2021). Do 3D face images capture cues of strength, weight, and height better than 2D face images do? *Adaptive Human Behavior and Physiology*, 7(3), 209–219.
- Childs, M., **Jones, A.**, Thwaites, P., Zdravković, S., Thorley, C., Suzuki, A., Shen, R., Ding, Q., Burns, E., Xu, H., & Tree, J. (2021). Do individual differences in face recognition ability moderate the other ethnicity effect? *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*, 47(7), 893–907.
- Moore, I., James, M., Brockwell, E., Perkins, J., **Jones, A.**, & Donnelly, G. (2021). Multidisciplinary, biopsychosocial factors contributing to return to running and running related stress urinary incontinence in postpartum women. *British Journal of Sports Medicine*, 55(22).
- **Jones, A.**, & Kramer, R. (2021). Facial first impressions form two clusters representing approach-avoidance. *Cognitive Psychology*, 126, 101387.
- **Jones, A.**, Schild, C., & Jones, B. (2021). Facial metrics generated from manually and automatically placed image landmarks are highly correlated. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 42(3), 186–193.
- Kramer, R., **Jones, A.**, & Gous, G. (2021). Individual differences in face and voice matching abilities: The relationship between accuracy and consistency. *Applied Cognitive Psychology*, 35(1), 192–202.
- **Jones, A.**, Jaeger, B., & Schild, C. (2021). No credible evidence for links between 2D:4D and COVID-19 outcomes: A probabilistic perspective on digit ratio, ACE variants, and national case fatalities. *Early Human Development*, 152, 105272.

2020

- Kramer, R., & **Jones, A.** (2020). Sequential effects in facial attractiveness judgments using cross-classified models: Investigating perceptual and response biases. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*, 46(12), 1476–1489.
- Kramer, R., Berry, C., **Jones, A.**, & Gous, G. (2020). Face familiarity and image-specific memory. *Perception*, 49(9).
- Crawford, M., Luik, A., Espie, C., Taylor, H., Burgess, H., **Jones, A.**, & Ong, J. (2020). Digital cognitive behavioral therapy for insomnia in women with chronic migraines. *Headache: The Journal of Head and Face Pain*, 60(5), 902–915.

2019

- Callow, N., Edwards, M., **Jones, A.**, Hardy, L., & Connell, S. (2019). Action dual tasks reveal differential effects of visual imagery perspectives on motor performance. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 72(6), 1401–1411.
- Russell, R., Batres, C., **Jones, A.**, & Porcheron, A. (2019). A role for contrast gain control in skin appearance. *Journal of Vision*, 19(11).
- Blagrove, M., Hale, S., Lockheart, J., Carr, M., **Jones, A.**, & Valli, K. (2019). Testing the empathy theory of dreaming: The relationships between dream sharing and trait and state empathy. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 10, 1351.
- **Jones, A.**, Tree, J., & Ward, R. (2019). Personality in faces: Implicit associations between appearance and personality. *European Journal of Social Psychology*, 49(3), 658–669.

- **Jones, A.**, & Jaeger, B. (2019). Biological bases of beauty revisited: The effect of symmetry, averageness, and sexual dimorphism on female facial attractiveness. *Symmetry*, 11(2), 279.

2018

- **Jones, A.** (2018). The influence of shape and colour cue classes on facial health perception. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 39(1), 19–29.

2017

- **Jones, A.**, Porcheron, A., & Russell, R. (2017). Makeup changes the apparent size of facial features. *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts*.
- **Jones, A.**, Batres, C., Porcheron, A., Sweda, J., Morizot, F., & Russell, R. (2017). Positive facial affect looks healthy. *Visual Cognition*, 1–12.
- Mason, K., Barlett, C., & **Jones, A.** (2017). The influence of the opposite sex on hypothetical aggressive inclinations. *Journal of Interpersonal Violence*, 088626051772483.
- Russell, R., Kramer, S., & **Jones, A.** (2017). Facial contrast declines with age but remains sexually dimorphic throughout adulthood. *Adaptive Human Behavior and Physiology*.
- Sumanapala, D., Fish, L., **Jones, A.**, & Cross, E. (2017). Have I grooved to this before? Discriminating practised and observed actions in a novel context. *Acta Psychologica*, 175, 42–49.

2016

- Diersch, N., **Jones, A.**, & Cross, E. (2016). The timing and precision of action prediction in the aging brain. *Human Brain Mapping*, 37(1), 54–66.
- Mileva, V., **Jones, A.**, Russell, R., Little, A., & Jones, A. (2016). Sex differences in the perceived dominance and prestige of women with and without cosmetics. *Perception*, 45(10), 1166–1183.
- **Jones, A.**, & Kramer, R. (2016). Facial cosmetics and attractiveness: Comparing the effect sizes of professionally-applied cosmetics and identity. *PLOS ONE*, 11(10), e0164218.
- Russell, R., Porcheron, A., Sweda, J., **Jones, A.**, Mauger, E., & Morizot, F. (2016). Facial contrast is a cue for perceiving health from the face. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*, 42(9), 1354–1362.
- **Jones, A.**, Porcheron, A., Sweda, J., Morizot, F., & Russell, R. (2016). Coloration in different areas of facial skin is a cue to health: The role of cheek redness and periorbital luminance in health perception. *Body Image*, 17, 57–66.

2015

- Kramer, R., & **Jones, A.** (2015). Do people's first names match their faces? *Journal of Articles in Support of the Null Hypothesis*, 12(1).
- Scott, N., **Jones, A.**, Kramer, R., & Ward, R. (2015). Facial dimorphism in autistic quotient scores. *Clinical Psychological Science*, 3(2), 230–241.
- **Jones, A.**, & Kramer, R. (2015). Facial cosmetics have little effect on attractiveness judgments compared with identity. *Perception*, 44(1), 79–86.
- **Jones, A.**, Russell, R., & Ward, R. (2015). Cosmetics alter biologically-based factors of beauty: Evidence from facial contrast. *Evolutionary Psychology*, 13(1).

2014

- **Jones, A.**, Kramer, R., & Ward, R. (2014). Miscalibrations in judgements of attractiveness with cosmetics. *The Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 67(10), 2060–2068.

2013

- Kramer, R., **Jones, A.**, & Sharma, D. (2013). Sequential effects in judgements of attractiveness: The influences of face race and sex. *PLOS ONE*, 8(12), e82226.
- Scott, N., Kramer, R., **Jones, A.**, & Ward, R. (2013). Facial cues to depressive symptoms and their associated personality attributions. *Psychiatry Research*, 208(1), 47–53.

2012

- **Jones, A.**, Kramer, R., & Ward, R. (2012). Signals of personality and health: The contributions of facial shape, skin texture, and viewing angle. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*, 38(6), 1353–1361.
- Kramer, R., **Jones, A.**, & Ward, R. (2012). A lack of sexual dimorphism in width-to-height ratio in white european faces using 2D photographs, 3D scans, and anthropometry. *PLOS ONE*, 7(8), e42705.